

V09 PHYSICAL ACTIVITY PROMOTION | O (MAX : 1 PT)

Intent : Encourage physical activity and exercise, by designing, implementing and monitoring physical activity incentive programs.

Summary : This WELL feature requires projects to provide physical activity incentives or promotion programs and monitor uptake of offerings.

Issue : Physical inactivity has emerged as a primary focus of public health, due to a rise in premature mortality and chronic diseases attributed to inactive lifestyles, including type 2 diabetes, cardiovascular disease, depression, stroke and some forms of cancer.^{1,2} Physical activity is intimately tied to prevention of these chronic conditions and overall health across the lifespan.³ In adolescent populations, physical activity is especially important for health, well-being and development.³

Solutions :

Health promotion programs in the workplace typically take a comprehensive approach to behavior change, including environmental design and behavioral strategies.³⁻⁵ There isn't a templated program that can be applied and deliver results in every workplace.³ It is, therefore, critical that projects take an integrative approach and design a program that is tailored to the needs of the population they serve. Physical activity incentives are one of many strategies that can be used. In a systematic review examining different incentives, conditional incentives – particularly those that rewarded positive physical activity behavior – were effective at improving physical activity levels as compared to unconditional incentives (e.g., subsidized memberships that do not require participation).⁶

Just as workplaces are a ubiquitous platform to reach working populations, programs targeting schools are a key avenue to reach student populations.³ In schools, some of the most common and well-recognized strategies to provide physical activity opportunities are through physical education curricula, recess, afterschool programs and sport, and activation of classrooms to incorporate more movement.^{3,7-9} It's also recommended that schools incorporate programs that address sedentary behavior, such as screen time, as part of a comprehensive approach to health promotion.¹⁰

PART 1 OFFER PHYSICAL ACTIVITY INCENTIVES (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

1: Incentives for eligible employees

The project or organization offers at least two of the following physical activity promotion programs to eligible employees:

- a. Rewards for physical activity engagement (e.g., prizes, financial rewards).
- b. A subsidy towards physical activity costs incurred by employees (e.g., membership fees or group fitness classes), including those incurred during business travel.
- c. Reductions in health care premiums based on physical activity engagement.
- d. Flexible work hours to accommodate physical activity.
- e. Paid time off for physical activity with a minimum of four days per calendar year. Days must be used towards physical activity engagement or recovery and may not be deducted from regular paid time off or other employer-provided time off from work (e.g., sick leave, standard paid holidays).

2: Employee utilization of incentive programs

One of the following requirements is met:

- a. The project or organization monitors utilization of incentive programs and demonstrates an annual utilization rate of 50% (i.e., at least 50% of eligible employees have utilized at least one incentive over the past year). Projects may report combined utilization rates across multiple incentives, as appropriate.
- b. The project or organization demonstrates an annual improvement in utilization of at least 10 percentage points. Projects may report combined utilization rates across multiple incentives, as appropriate.

3: Physical activity for students

Early childhood education, primary and secondary schools develop and implement the following programs for students:

- a. A program that aims to reduce daily time spent in the following sedentary behaviors:
 1. TV viewing.
 2. Recreational computer or smartphone use.
 3. Gaming.
- b. A program that aims to promote daily physical activity through at least one of the following:
 1. Teaching strategies that incorporate movement and activity into the lesson.
 2. Physical education.
 3. Recess or similar physical activity breaks.

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